



iMessage in Google Messages

Google Messages will now be able to properly display iMessage reactions. <https://digit.in/mar22-09>



Eccentric Black Hole Merger

Scientists confirm the first-ever detection of a gravitational wave event predicted by Einstein's Theory of Relativity. <https://digit.in/mar22-10>



Top Android 13 Developer Preview Features

With Android 13 just around the corner, it might be a good idea to get to know it a bit better

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e've gotten to see the first developer preview for Android 13 and it has introduced a brand new

theming system alongside a few privacy-centric features. Back in December, we saw an Android 13 build leak that allowed users to change UI language on a per app basis and sure enough, that feature was a part of the first developer build.

Alongside that, Google also seems to be building upon its Project Mainline which focuses on making it easier to release handpicked features on devices that are running older versions of Android via software updates and to make sure that devs have enough time on their hands to optimise their apps for Android 13, Google plans to release developer builds of Android 13 all the way through the month of March and Beta builds will be released throughout July, at the latest. With the release of system images for compatible phones such as the Pixel 6 pro, Pixel 6, Pixel 5a 5G, Pixel 5, and older Pixel Devices as well.

So now, here are a few of the top features of Android 13 that we felt deserve a mention.

PRIVACY-CENTRIC FEATURES

Google announced a few privacy-centric

features, the first of them being that users would no longer have to grant full storage access to apps when they try to send a picture through it. Instead of granting full access to the app, your phone will give the app access to only the pictures you want to share using that app. This feature will also be being rolled out to phones running Android 12 and 11 through software updates.

The second privacy-centric update is regarding the new Wi-Fi permission system that separates it from location data requirements. In simple words, apps would only be able to detect other devices that would have their Wi-Fi functionality turned on in their nearby vicinity but won't be able to extract location data from the Wi-Fi connection hotspot.

NEW THEMES

Starting with the new cosmetic designs, Google's own Material You design received an uplift and became more universal. All apps can now

switch to a monochrome icon design with round backgrounds that match the existing theme colours and apart from that, it also automatically inverts the icon's colour depending on the system theme you have chosen, i.e. Dark or Light.

BRAND NEW TILE PLACEMENT API

This is another cool feature in the newest Android 13 Dev update. This feature will make it easier for apps to offer an active Quick Settings menu that will appear in the notification bar. So basically won't have to go deep into some obscure settings in order to do the something. Let us show you how this works with the help of an example.

Let's assume you have a robot vacuum. Now, using this feature, you could have a small dedicated space in your notification bar which would show you the option of starting or stopping your vacuum whenever you please instead of having to open its companion app. Another example would be to utilise a modern car's distance startup feature on your phone. This feature that would allow you to turn your car on using nothing but your phone's notification tab.

TAP TO TRANSFER

Another interesting addition to Android 13 that we got to see was

